title: "Quality Assurance & Audit Policy" version: "1.0" effectiveDate: "[Insert Date]" reviewDate: "[Insert Date – usually annually]" appliesTo: "All staff, contractors, and volunteers at [INSERT CARE HOME NAME]"

Quality Assurance & Audit Policy

1. Policy Statement

At [INSERT CARE HOME NAME], we are committed to delivering safe, effective, and person-centred care. Our quality assurance and audit processes are designed to continuously monitor, evaluate, and improve the services we provide.

We aim to:

- Ensure compliance with statutory and regulatory requirements, including the Health and Social Care Act 2008 (Regulated Activities) Regulations 2014 and CQC Fundamental Standards.
- Monitor and improve the quality of care and support provided to residents.
- Promote a culture of openness, accountability, and continuous improvement.
- Involve residents, families, and staff in shaping the quality of our service.

2. Purpose

This policy sets out the framework for:

- Quality assurance systems within the care home.
- Internal and external audit processes.
- Monitoring compliance with policies, procedures, and care standards.
- Identifying, reporting, and acting on areas for improvement.

3. Scope

This policy applies to:

- All staff, agency workers, and volunteers.
- All aspects of service delivery, including care, governance, health and safety, training, and record keeping.
- Residents, families, and external partners (where feedback informs quality improvement).

4. Roles and Responsibilities

Registered Manager:

- Has overall responsibility for quality assurance and audit systems.

- Ensures audits are planned, completed, and reviewed regularly.
- Reports findings and improvement plans to senior management and regulatory bodies where required.

Senior Staff / Team Leaders:

- Conduct regular audits in designated areas (e.g., medication, infection control, care planning).
- Implement corrective actions and monitor progress.
- Provide feedback to staff and support improvement initiatives.

All Staff:

- Adhere to policies, procedures, and quality standards.
- Participate in audits, surveys, and quality monitoring activities.
- Report concerns or suggestions for improvement.

5. Quality Assurance Measures

- Resident and Family Feedback – regular surveys, meetings, and complaints/compliments procedures.
- Staff Feedback – supervision, appraisals, and team meetings used to gather input.
- Care Plan Reviews – conducted regularly to ensure person-centred care.
- Regulatory Compliance Monitoring – adherence to CQC requirements and local authority standards.
- Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) – tracked to monitor outcomes (e.g., falls, safeguarding incidents, staff training compliance).

6. Audit Programme

- Routine Audits (monthly, quarterly, annually depending on topic) will include:
    - Medication management
    - Infection prevention and control
    - Health and safety / fire safety
    - Care plans and documentation
    - Staffing levels, training, and supervision
    - Complaints and incident reporting
    - GDPR and confidentiality compliance
- Audit Cycle:
    - Plan the audit (identify focus and schedule).
    - Conduct the audit (gather data, review records, observe practice).
    - Report findings (share with relevant staff and management).
    - Develop action plan (address areas for improvement).
    - Monitor progress (follow-up audits and reviews).

7. Continuous Improvement

- Findings from audits feed into the Quality Improvement Plan (QIP).
- Lessons learned from incidents, complaints, and inspections inform changes.
- Staff training and development linked to audit outcomes.
- Successes and improvements communicated to staff, residents, and families.

8. Monitoring and Records

- Audit schedules and results documented and retained securely.
- Action plans tracked until completion.
- Quality assurance reports made available to the CQC, commissioners, or other stakeholders on request.

9. References

- Health and Social Care Act 2008 (Regulated Activities) Regulations 2014
- CQC Fundamental Standards – Regulation 17 (Good Governance)
- NICE Guidance – Care and Support
- Skills for Care – Quality Assurance in Care Homes

10. Related Policies

- Record Keeping / Confidentiality / GDPR Policy
- Training & Development / Supervision Policy
- Safeguarding Adults Policy
- Complaints and Compliments Policy
- Health & Safety Policy
- Infection Prevention & Control Policy

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